



SANKET RAY
PRESIDENT, COCA-COLA
INDIA & SOUTHWEST ASIA

“There is no question of doing a *lassi* or a *chaas*, since we cannot offer a differentiated product, nor do we have a cost advantage”



ARNAB ROY
VP & HEAD OF MARKETING,
COCA-COLA INDIA &
SOUTHWEST ASIA

“The opportunity [for Maaza] is huge, but dealing with supply chain issues is a reality. [In 2021], the mango crop failed and the situation was tough”



RAMESH CHAUHAN
CHAIRMAN, BISLERI
INTERNATIONAL

“You have to deal with high volumes and low margins [in the packaged water business]. Since water is a commodity, building a brand is not easy”

to 4 million. “Just increasing the number of outlets is a huge job. At the end of it, we are a hub company and the entire network has to get together,” he says, adding wryly that his strategy is simple and boring.

Analysts think it makes a lot of sense for Coca-Cola to stick to its core business. According to Apoorva Nema, Practice Head (beverages team) at data analytics and consulting firm GlobalData, growth drivers’ categories typically generate lower margins than the legacy CSD business. “While price points in high-protein milk, for example, are higher than that of soft drinks, the bottom line is relatively less attractive.”



LET’S TAKE A deeper look at the contra approach. Logically, a soft drinks major would spend a lot of money in the second quarter of the calendar year to coincide with summer. However, the folks at Coca-Cola instead decided to spend more in Q3 (July to September), on the

runway to the festive season. Why so? Marketing head Roy says the management decided to ask themselves a simple question: are we being sharp with our brands?

The answer was a quantitative analysis. For example, Sprite typically sees 100 new consumers coming in during peak summer, 80 of whom exit by the end of the season. “Then, we have to build this process all over again. That led to us increasing investments in Q3 and building more occasions to consume each of our brands,” he says. For example, a Maaza campaign has the drink consumed

₹15,000
CRORE
ESTIMATED SIZE OF INDIA’S ORGANISED JUICES MARKET. MAAZA FROM THE COCA-COLA STABLE IS THE MARKET LEADER